



Uninstalling Linux, converting videotapes to VCDs, sharing Internet connections, synchronising e-mail across PCs—find all your answers here

Crashing Visual Basic

Q. I seem to be having a very queer problem. Whenever I work with Visual Basic 6.0, I get the following error message: "This program has performed an illegal operation and will be shut down. If the problem persists, contact the program vendor. VB6 caused an invalid page fault in module VB6.EXE at 0167:004581f1."

I have thoroughly scanned my system for viruses and also uninstalled and reinstalled the application a number of times. Please tell me the cause of this error and the solution.

Vaibhav Bhawsar
Bhopal

A Since you haven't mentioned when the program crashes, it will be difficult to point out the exact cause of the error. Visual Basic has many documented bugs; monitor the program when you are working with it and you will notice a pattern of events every time it crashes—say, while using a particular ActiveX control, an API (Application Programming Interface), loading certain kinds of images, etc. You can trace the cause of the error from here and fix the required component. The best solution is to install the latest patches and Service Pack. You can get Service Pack 3 at <http://www.microsoft.com/msdownload/vstudio/full.asp>.

Relentless Me

Q. Whenever I try to use Windows Me Help, I get the error message, 'The initialization of the Help Center failed'. I tried reinstalling Windows Me, but to no avail. Whenever I run MS Access XP and some other programs, I get an error message that reads, 'ActiveX component can't create object'. Please advise.

Neil
Via e-mail

A This can happen if the Help and Support Center in Windows Me is not properly configured because the Windows Management Instrumentation (WMI) Setup failed. Open the command

Repairing Windows XP

Q. I have Windows 98 and Windows XP installed on different partitions. I was playing a game on XP when suddenly the lights went out. Since then, the Start Menu and taskbar just don't appear. Now I have to open Task Manager every time I want to start an application. Please suggest a way to get the taskbar back without re-installing Windows.

Harsh
Via e-mail

A This can happen if the Windows settings for one or more user accounts are corrupted. The simplest way to solve this would be to repair Windows XP. Run the installation



ILLUSTRATIONS: Mahesh Benkar

from the Windows XP installation disc and choose 'Repair the existing installation'. The repair option will only replace Windows files, leaving all other programs intact.

You can also get around the problem by creating a new user account. Press [F8] as Windows XP starts booting and select Safe Mode on the Windows Advanced Options menu. When prompted to select which operating system to start, select Microsoft Windows XP. Choose Administrator as the user and enter the administrator password. Click Start, right-click My Computer and click Manage. You can create a new user under Local Users and Groups. Restart Windows normally and log on as the new user. This should solve the problem, but you may need to reinstall some of the programs and copy data such as documents from the My Documents folder or e-mail from the old user account.